Gmail

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The fear that shows up right before alignment

1 message

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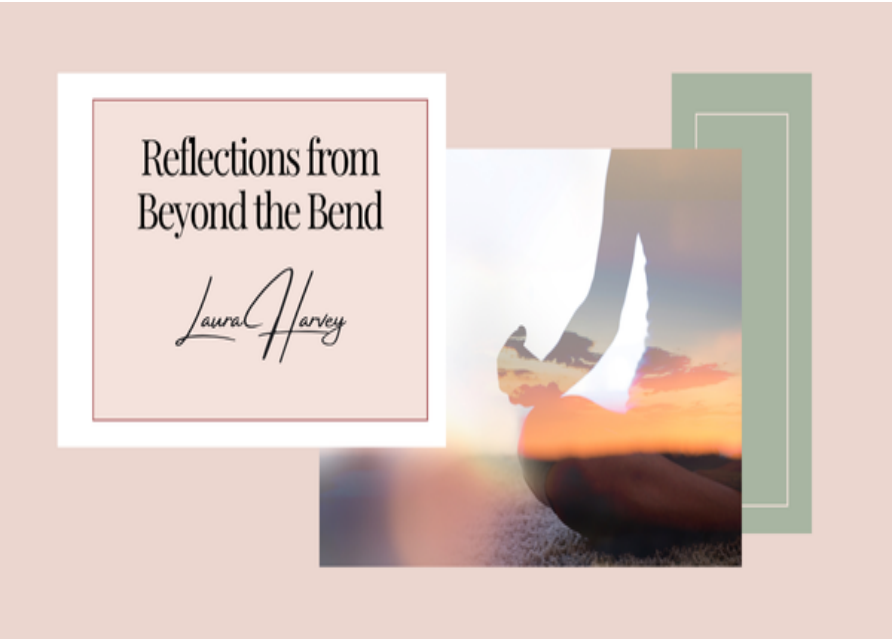
BEYOND THE BEND YOGA



Hello Laura

Lately, I've been spending time with *The Alchemist* by Paulo Coelho. It's a book I first read many years ago, but this time it's meeting me in a very different place. Instead of feeling inspirational or symbolic, it's been acting more like a mirror, drawing my attention to patterns I recognize in myself as I'm living them.

One theme in particular has been lingering with me, especially as I notice how fear shows up when something meaningful is beginning to shift. I've been sitting with that, watching it move in my own body and choices, and letting it teach me in real time.

That's what this week's Wellness Wisdom is exploring.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

This Week's Wellness Wisdom

When the gatekeeper appears

By Laura Harvey | Beyond the Bend Yoga

As I've been reading The Alchemist, something about the way it speaks about fear has been staying with me. Not as an idea to understand, but as something that's been quietly reshaping how I recognize certain moments in my own life.

One of the things the book points toward is that fear doesn't always appear at the beginning of a journey. Sometimes it shows up much later, when something already feels close. Real. Life-altering, even. And once I saw that, I couldn't unsee it.

This kind of fear feels different from panic or uncertainty. It feels reasonable. Measured. It asks questions that sound thoughtful and protective. Why now. Why disrupt what's working. Isn't this enough.

Who am I to want more than this. At this stage of life, those questions carry real weight because they're informed by experience.

In The Alchemist, fear isn't framed as something to conquer. It appears more like a gatekeeper, standing at a threshold. And what's been striking for me is realizing how often, in the past, I've mistaken that gatekeeper for a warning sign. I've taken its presence as evidence that I shouldn't move forward, rather than as a signal that something meaningful was about to change.

What I'm noticing now is that this gatekeeper tends to appear only when something inside has already begun to align. After the fantasizing phase has passed. After there's a quieter, steadier sense of yes, often felt in the body before it's clear in words. The fear doesn't erase that yes. It rises alongside it.

This feels especially true in midlife. Earlier fears often came from not knowing enough. This kind of fear comes from knowing exactly what's at stake. Knowing what it takes to rebuild. Knowing how much energy change requires. Knowing how hard-won peace can be. So the fear doesn't shout. It whispers. And it often sounds like self-protection.

What's been shifting for me is learning not to run from that fear or immediately obey it. Instead, I'm practicing staying with it. Sitting in the discomfort. Letting the fear be present without treating it as a verdict. Seeing it not as a message to abandon myself, but as a sign that something important and possibly very beautiful is trying to come through.

I don't have this mastered. I'm very much living it. But this reframe has changed how I meet those moments. The gatekeeper no longer feels like the end of the road. It feels like the place where something honest asks for courage, patience, and trust.

I can't help but wonder how often this same fear appears for other women too, right at the edge of a real shift. Not as a sign to stop, but as an invitation to stay long enough to see what's on the other side.

That feels worth sitting with.

A Gentle Place to Land

We’ve crossed the threshold into the new year. By now, the world is

OUR WEEKLY PRACTICE:

Meeting the Gatekeeper in Real Time

At some point this week, you may notice that familiar, reasonable fear show up. The one that sounds thoughtful. Protective. The one that asks you to pause, delay, or stay where you are.

When you notice it, try this.

First, **don't argue with it**.
Don't try to talk yourself out of the fear or rush yourself into courage.
Simply pause.

Then, gently **bring your attention into the body**.

Notice where the fear is registering physically.
Is it in the chest, the belly, the throat, the shoulders?
Does it feel tight, heavy, fluttery, warm, or still?

Let yourself stay with that sensation for a few breaths, without needing it to change. You're not trying to calm it or interpret it. You're simply letting it be felt.

Now, silently acknowledge it with a simple phrase, something like:
"I see you."
or
"You're here."

Then ask yourself one quiet question, not to answer immediately, but just to let it land:
"What is this fear protecting?"
or
"What feels important right now?"

You don't need clarity. You don't need a plan.
The practice is simply **staying present long enough not to run**.

After a few moments, gently return to whatever you were doing, carrying the awareness that the gatekeeper has been met, not obeyed or dismissed.

You can repeat this practice anytime the fear shows up again. Each time, you're building trust in your ability to stay.

Why this practice matters

This isn't about overcoming fear.
It's about changing your relationship to it.

You're learning to recognize the gatekeeper not as a stop sign, but as a signal that something meaningful is near, and that you are capable of standing at the threshold without abandoning yourself.

That, quietly, is the work.

A Closing Thought

If fear is showing up at the edge of something in your life, perhaps it doesn't need to be solved or silenced. Perhaps it's simply asking to be felt and understood. You can take your time with that. The gate will still be there when you're ready.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

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